

Figure 1: Timeline

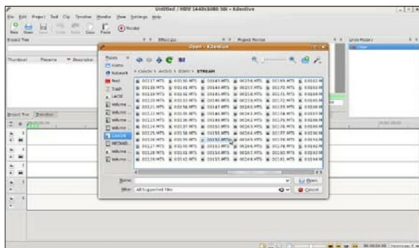


Figure 2: Import HD content

so much that I dropped the idea of buying some creepy machine to run FCP. I trust that within a couple of years, Kdenlive will be much more advanced and can be used 'freely'.

The time-line of Kdenlive has improved a million times. You can now pull clips like you move a knife through butter (Figure 1). You can add multiple video as well as audio tracks. You can freely move clips from one track to another, as well as to and fro. Kdenlive supports HD video, so it's actually like taking a walk in the park to import videos directly from my Canon VIXIA HF 11 (Figure 2). However, like any other software—including FCP or Sony Vegas Pro—you can't play HD-imported video smoothly; you have to first transcode (render) it into the

desired AVI format so that you can edit the video. Kdenlive now supports so many formats that you will never have to worry (Figure 3). Once the clip is rendered in the desired format, you can import it again and start editing.

Additionally, you have a rich set of audio/video effects, besides transitions effects. This will enable you to make good quality short films without spending a penny.

Another advantage of using Kdenlive is that you may not have to upgrade your machine. According to the project website, it would work for you if you have a 32- or 64-bit modern processor (AMD64 or Intel mono/dual core systems); a fast hard disc with more than 20 GB of free disc space; a Firewire interface for camcorder capture; at least 1 GB of

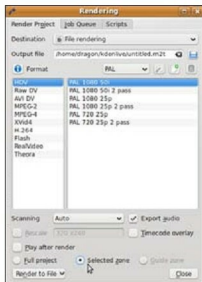


Figure 3: Render formats available

RAM and a screen size of 1024 x 768 pixels or more.

For advanced use and semi-professional work, Kdenlive recommends investing in a recent computer with AMD Phenom Quad-core processor; 4 GB of RAM; three SATA discs for RAID-5 usage (any Linux distribution offers RAID-5 without an additional controller), and a recent video card with dual display.

Advanced users can stay updated through a very active and supportive forum at www.kdenlive.org/forum/users-forums/video-effects-and-transitions.

In conclusion, I'd say Kdenlive has now everything an amateur wants, but to become a full-fledged editor there are a few more miles to cover—it's just a matter of time. It would be great if more users could test Kdenlive and share their experiences with us. **END** 

By Swapnil Bhattiya

A Free Software fund-a-mental-ist and Charles Bukowski fan, Swapnil also writes fiction and tries to find cracks in a proprietary company's 'paper armours'. He is a big movie buff, and prefers listening to music at such loud volumes that he's gone partially deaf when it comes to identifying anything positive about proprietary companies. Oh, and he is also the assistant editor of EPYTimes.com.